HWFC Trello – Quick User Guide

Trello is used by the HWFC Marketing & Communications team to keep track of jobs, see who is working on them, and record progress.

You do not need to be an experienced Trello user. For most tasks, you only need to know how to **open a card, update it and move it between lists**.

1. How the Board Works

Our board is divided into four lists:

Backlog

Jobs that we know need to be done, but which have not yet been started.

Examples might include:

- Preparing publicity material.
- Contacting local organisations.
- Reviewing photographs.
- Planning a future event.

In Progress

Move a card here when someone has started working on it.

A card in **In Progress** should normally have someone taking responsibility for it.

Blocked

Move a card here when work has started but cannot continue.

For example:

- Waiting for information.
- Waiting for approval.
- Waiting for another person to complete something first.

Add a comment to the card explaining what is blocking it.

Done

Move the card here when the task has been completed.

The board should therefore give everyone a quick view of:

What needs doing → What is being worked on → What is stuck → What has been completed

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2. Cards

Each job is represented by a **card**.

Click or tap a card to open it.

A card can contain:

- A task title.
- A description explaining what needs to be done.
- The person or people responsible.
- Comments and progress updates.
- A due date where appropriate.
- Checklists for tasks with several steps.

- Attachments or links.

You do not need to use every Trello feature on every card.

The most important thing is that somebody looking at the card can understand:

What needs to be done, who is doing it, and what the current position is.

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3. Taking Responsibility for a Task

If you agree to work on a task:

1. Open the card.
2. Add yourself as a member if you are not already assigned.
3. Move the card from **Backlog** to **In Progress**.
4. Read the description and any existing comments.
5. Add a comment if useful to say what you are going to do next.

Do not leave a task in the Backlog once work has genuinely started.

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4. Updating a Task

You do not need to provide a report every time you do something.

Add a comment when there is useful information that other team members should know.

For example:

> Contacted the organiser today. They are going to confirm dates later this week.

or:

> First draft completed. Waiting for approval before publishing.

Comments create a useful history of the task and mean information is not lost in WhatsApp messages or private conversations.

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5. If You Cannot Continue

If something prevents you from completing the task:

1. Add a comment explaining the problem.
2. Say what is needed before work can continue.
3. Move the card to **Blocked**.

For example:

> Waiting for confirmation of the event venue before the poster can be completed.

Once the problem has been resolved, move the card back to **In Progress**.

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6. Completing a Task

When the job is finished:

1. Add a final comment if useful.
2. Make sure any important links, documents or information have been recorded on the card.
3. Move the card to **Done**.

For example:

NIWFF contacted and updated website details supplied. Task complete.

This allows the team to see what has actually been achieved.

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7. Adding a New Task

If you identify a new piece of work that needs doing, create a new card in **Backlog**.

Use a short, action-based title.

Good:

Contact local newspapers about walking football

Less useful:

Newspapers

Add enough information to the description for another team member to understand the job.

Where possible, include:

- What needs to be done.
- Why it is needed.
- Any useful contact details or links.
- Any deadline.
- Any dependency on another task.

Do not worry about making the description perfect. It can be improved later.

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8. Checklists

For a task with several distinct steps, add a checklist rather than creating lots of separate cards.

For example, a card called **Prepare Event Publicity** could contain:

☐ Confirm event details
☐ Prepare poster
☐ Get approval
☐ Publish on Facebook
☐ Send to local community groups

Tick each item as it is completed.

If one of those steps becomes a substantial job in its own right, it may be better to create a separate card.

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9. Due Dates

Add a due date when there is a genuine deadline.

Examples include:

- An event date.
- A publication deadline.
- A deadline agreed at a team meeting.

Avoid adding arbitrary deadlines simply to make every card have a date.

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10. A Good Trello Habit

Whenever you work on a task, ask yourself:

Does the Trello card still show the true position?

If not, spend a few seconds updating it.

Usually this simply means:

- Moving the card.
- Adding or changing the person responsible.
- Adding a short comment.
- Ticking a checklist item.

Keeping the board current is more important than making it complicated.

The One-Minute Version

Remember these four rules:

Not started? → Backlog **Working on it?** → In Progress **Cannot continue?** → Blocked **Finished?** → Done

And whenever something important changes, **update the card so the rest of the team knows**.